

Freshness you can see

What Instamart’s recent 1★–2★ reviews say about the items that arrive, compared with Blinkit and Zepto, and one idea.

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Review facts

1,688 Instamart complaints · 21 Aug – 28 Sep 2026

Complaints about damaged, expired or poor-quality items **17% → 28%**
share of specific complaints, week of 24 Aug to week of 21 Sep

Complaints that mention an expired item **10 → 20**
per week, over the same five weeks

Late delivery, the lowest of the three apps **12%**
of specific complaints, 21–28 Sep 2026

“expiry dates on perishable items should be shown upfront on the app so customers can decide accordingly.”
1★ review · 20 Sep 2026

“Specific” complaints name a problem: 807 of the 1,688.

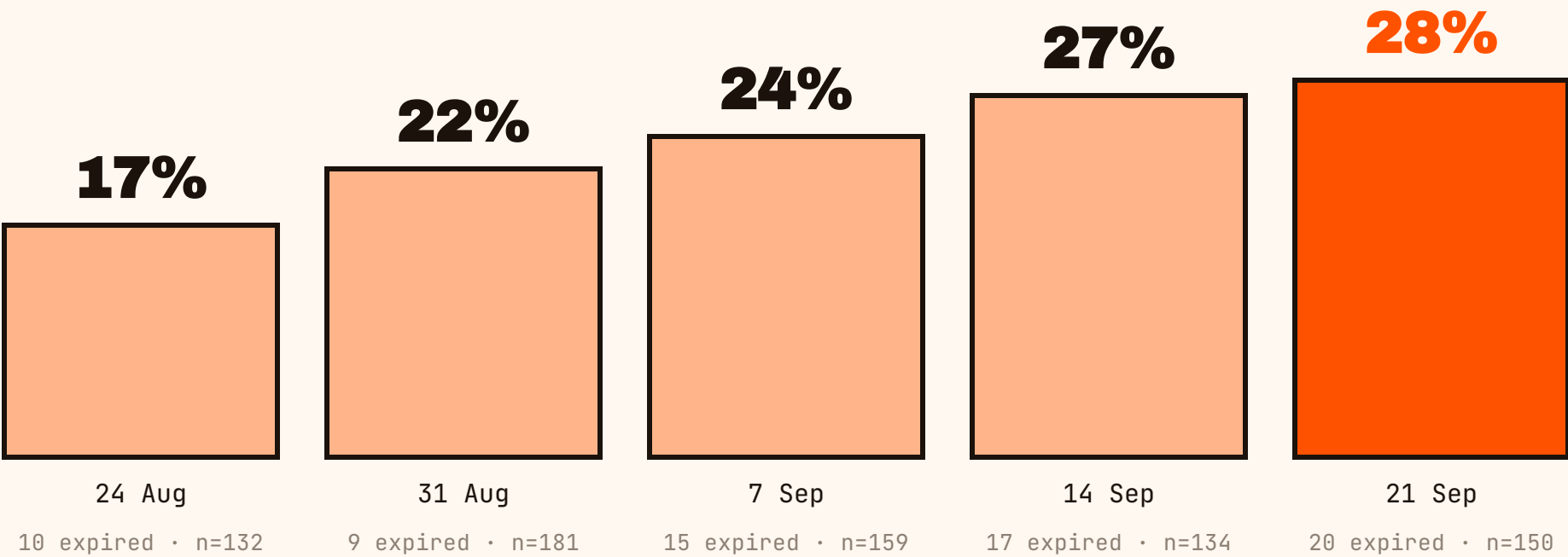
CHECK BEFORE YOU PACK

Instamart has the **highest share of quality complaints** of the three, and the fewest about late delivery

SHARE OF SPECIFIC COMPLAINTS	INSTAMART	ZEPTO	BLINKIT	QUALITY COMPLAINTS 28% of specific complaints, against 26% at Zepto and 17% at Blinkit WHAT'S WORKING The fewest complaints about late delivery: 12% of specific complaints, against 14% at Zepto and 17% at Blinkit.
Damaged, expired or poor quality	28.2%	25.6%	16.9%	
Customer support	37.8%	43.7%	22.5%	
Refund or return trouble	28.2%	32.3%	29.3%	
Fees and charges	14.1%	6.7%	12.2%	
Late delivery	12.2%	13.9%	17%	
Missing or wrong items	9%	13.9%	6.1%	
Same eight days for all three, 21–28 Sep 2026. Instamart 156 of 297 complaints are specific; Zepto 403 of 629; Blinkit 788 of 1,724.				

Quality complaints have **risen five weeks in a row**, with expired items doubling

SHARE OF SPECIFIC COMPLAINTS ABOUT DAMAGED, EXPIRED OR POOR-QUALITY ITEMS, BY WEEK



Context: in July 2026, FSSAI issued nine notices to Instamart over expired and spoiled products (The Statesman, 11 Jul 2026).

“Also expiry dates on perishable items should be shown upfront on the app so customers can decide accordingly.”

1★ • 20 Sep 2026

“the delivered stock was already EXPIRED 2 months ago!”

1★ • 15 Sep 2026

“gave me an expired Ataa pack aashirwad and no response in the chat”

1★ • 24 Sep 2026

THE FIRST QUOTE IS A CUSTOMER SUGGESTING THE FIX

Make freshness **visible and checkable**, from shelf to doorstep

#	CHANGE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY
1	Show the date before checkout	Expiry or best-before on the product page for packaged food, and printed on the bill.	A customer asked for exactly this on 20 Sep.
2	Block near-expiry items at packing	A scan at the dark store flags anything within a set number of days of expiry before it goes in the bag.	Expired-item mentions doubled in five weeks.
3	Photo in, refund out	A photo of the date on the pack triggers an instant refund, with no chat needed.	“no response in the chat”
4	Alert the store, not just the customer	When expired-item reports cluster at one dark store, flag it the same day for a shelf check.	Complaints name specific items and dates.
HOW I’D KNOW IT WORKED		WHAT I CAN’T SEE	
Expired-item reports per 10,000 items delivered, by dark store, every week.		Instamart’s stock data or current checks. Some of this may already exist; treat these as starting points.	
Guardrail: items removed at packing don’t push up “out of stock” complaints.			